

Sacha Yesilaltay | Curriculum Vitae

✉ sachal.altay@gmail.com • University of Zurich

Summary

I study misinformation, news, and social media, using a variety of methods such as surveys, online experiments, and social media field experiments.

Scientific accomplishments.....

I have published **44 peer reviewed articles** – 26 of them as first author. Most articles have been published in leading communication and psychology journals. I have also published in general interest journals, with four articles in *Nature Human Behaviour*. My work on misinformation has been impactful. My articles have been cited more than **3200 times** (h-index = 29).

I have been invited to present my work in 24 labs around the world and have given 22 presentations at international conferences.

I am an advocate of **open science** and have experience in writing preregistrations, registered reports, as well as sharing data and scripts. I enjoy **data visualization** (in R) and think it's central to scientific understanding and communication.

Professional activities and leadership.....

I have reviewed more than 80 articles, including for *NHB*, *PNAS*, *Nat Com*, *Pol Com*, *NMS*, *JESP* and *Cognition*.

I have supervised 3 master students and one PhD student. I published articles with them, including one in *Nature Human Behaviour* on which I am the corresponding author.

Outreach.....

I am a dedicated science communicator. I have given **32 talks** and have written **36 articles** for the general public, journalists (*Reuters*, *Libération*, *Le Point*) and policy makers (*European commission*, *Assemblée Nationale*, *DITP*, *NASEM*).

I have been frequently quoted in the **popular press**, such as in *TIME*, the *Washington post*, *Bloomberg*, *Politico*, *Wired*, *Nature*, *Science*, *Deutsche Welle*, *Le Figaro*, or *Le Parisien*.

Jobs and Affiliations

AI and Society Institute - PSL
Affiliated Researcher,

Paris
2025–present

University of Zurich - IPZ

Postdoctoral Researcher,

Zurich

2023–present

University of Oxford - Reuters Institute

Postdoctoral Researcher,

Oxford

2021–2023

Education

École Normale Supérieure

PhD supervisor : Hugo Mercier,

Thesis title : Understanding Misinformation and Fighting for Information

Paris

2018–2021

École Normale Supérieure

M.A. Cognitive Science (Cogmaster),

Paris

2016–2018

Paris Diderot University

Bachelor of Sociology,

Paris

2013–2016

Publications

† indicates equal contribution

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles.....

44. **Altay, S.** (2026) Rethinking the Problem of Misinformation and Its Solutions. *New Media & Society*.
43. Baudouin, N., **Altay, S.**, & Mercier, H. (2026) Do your own research (?) : a weak link between conspiracism and preference for first hand evidence in a perceptual task. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*.
42. Hoes, E. & **Altay, S.** (2026) Debriefings in Misinformation Research Should Include Fact-Checks to Reduce False Beliefs and Increase Perceived Learning. *Political Science Research and Methods*.
41. **Altay, S.**, Hoes, E. & Wojcieszak, M. (2025) News Informs and Boosts Discernment : A replication in France and Germany. *The International Journal of Press/Politics*.
40. **Altay, S.** (2025) Who Is Concerned About Online False News and Why? Evidence From 46 Countries Between 2018 and 2023. *Information, Communication & Society*.
39. **Altay, S.**, Andi, S., Badrinathan, S., Mont'Alverne, C., Toff, B., Kleis Nielsen, R., & Fletcher, R. (2025). The small effects of short user corrections on misinformation in Brazil, India, and the UK. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*.
38. **Altay, S.**, Hoes, E. & Wojcieszak, M. (2025) News on Social Media Boosts Knowledge, Belief Accuracy, and Trust : A Field Experiment on Instagram and WhatsApp. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
37. Pfander, J. & **Altay, S.** (2025) Spotting False News and Doubting True News : A Meta-Analysis of News Judgements. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
36. Ejaz, W., **Altay, S.**, & Ittefaq, M. (2025) How Effective Are Fact-checks in Pakistan and Who Engages with Them? *Information, Communication & Society*.
35. Lyons, B., Modirrousta-Galian, A., **Altay, S.**, & Salovich, NA. (2025) Reducing Blind Spots? Performance Feedback Reduces Relative Confidence but Does Not Improve Subsequent News Discernment. *Collabra : Psychology*.

34. **Altay, S.**, & Gilardi, F. (2024) People Are Skeptical of Headlines Labeled as AI-Generated, Even if True or Human-Made, Because They Assume Full AI Automation. *PNAS Nexus*.
33. **Altay, S.†**, De Angelis, A†. & Hoes, E†. (2024) Media literacy tips promoting reliable news improve discernment and enhance trust in traditional media. *Communications Psychology*.
32. **Altay, S.†**, Lyons, B†. & Modirrousta-Galian, A. (2024) Exposure to Higher Rates of False News Erodes Media Trust and Fuels Overconfidence. *Mass Communication and Society*.
31. **Altay, S.**, Fletcher, R. & Kleis Nielsen, R. (2024) News Participation Is Declining : Evidence From 46 Countries Between 2015 and 2022. *New Media & Society*.
30. Ejaz, W., **Altay, S.**, Fletcher, R. & Kleis Nielsen, R. (2024) Trust Is Key : Determinants of Belief in Misinformation about Climate Change in Eight Countries. *New Media & Society*.
29. **Altay, S.**, Nera, K., Ejaz, W., Schöpfer, C. & Tomas, F. (2023) Conspiracy Believers Claim to Be Free Thinkers but (Under)Use Advice Like Everyone Else. *British Journal of Social Psychology*.
28. Schmid, P., **Altay, S.** & Scherer, L. (2023) The Psychological Impacts and Message Features of Planetary Health Misinformation. *European Psychologist*.
27. Simon, F. †, **Altay, S.†**, & Mercier, H†. (2023) Misinformation Reloaded? Fears about the Impact of Generative AI on Misinformation are Overblown. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*.
26. Ejaz, W., **Altay, S.**, & Naeem, G. (2023) Smartphone use and well-being in Pakistan : Comparing the effect of self-reported and actual smartphone use. *Digital Health*.
25. **Altay, S.**, & Mercier, H. (2023) Happy Thoughts : The Role of Communion in Accepting and Sharing Epistemically Suspect Beliefs. *British Journal of Social Psychology*.
24. Marie, A., **Altay, S.**, & Strickland, B. (2023) Moralization Amplifies “Myside” Sharing, but Targeted Interventions Can Reduce It. *PNAS Nexus*.
23. **Altay, S.**, Berriche, M., Farkas, J., Heuer, H., & Rathje, S. (2023) A Survey of Expert Views on Misinformation : Definitions, Determinants, Solutions, and Future of the Field. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*.
22. **Altay, S.** & Acerbi, A. (2023). People believe misinformation is a threat because they assume others are gullible. *New Media & Society*.
21. **Altay, S.**, Nielsen, RK. & Fletcher, R. . (2023) News can help! The impact of news media and digital platform use on awareness of and belief in COVID-19 misinformation. *International Journal of Press & Politics*.
20. Herrera-Masurel, A. †, **Altay, S. †**, & Mercier, H. (2023) Does nuclear energy produce neodymium? Negative perception of nuclear energy drives the assumption that it is polluting. *Journal of Experimental Psychology : Applied*.
19. **Altay, S. †**, Berriche, M. †, & Acerbi, A. (2023). Misinformation on Misinformation : Conceptual and Methodological Challenges. *Social Media + Society*.
18. **Altay, S.**, Nielsen, RK. & Fletcher, R. . (2022) Quantifying the “infodemic” : People turned to trustworthy news outlets during the 2020 pandemic. *Journal of Quantitative Description : Digital Media*.
17. Liu, S†, **Altay, S. †**, & Mercier, H., (2022) Being green or being nice? People are more likely to share nicer but potentially less impactful green messages. *Climatic Change*.

16. **Altay, S.**, Schwartz, M., Hacquin, AS., Allard, A., Blancke, S. & Mercier, H. (2022) Scaling up Interactive Argumentation by Providing Counterarguments with a Chatbot. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
15. Acerbi, A. †, **Altay, S.** †, & Mercier, H. (2022) Research note : Fighting for information or fighting misinformation? *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*.
14. Hoogeveen, S., ... **Altay, S.**, ... & G, Nilsonne. (2022) A many-analysts approach to the relation between religiosity and well-being. *Religion, Brain & Behavior*.
13. Hoogeveen, S., Haaf, J. M., Bulbulia, J., Ross, R. M., McKay, R., **Altay, S.**, ... & van Elk, M. (2022) The Einstein effect : Global evidence for scientific source credibility effects and the influence of religiosity. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
12. de Araujo, E. †, **Altay, S.** †, Bor, A., & Mercier, H. (2022) Dominant Jerks : People infer dominance from the utterance of challenging and offensive statements. *Social Psychological Bulletin*.
11. **Altay, S.**, de Araujo, E. & Mercier, H. (2021) “If this account is true, it is most enormously wonderful” : Interestingness-if-true and the sharing of true and false news. *Digital Journalism*.
10. **Altay, S.**, Hacquin, A., Chevallier, C. †, & Mercier, H. †. (2021). Information Delivered by a Chatbot Has a Positive Impact on COVID-19 Vaccines Attitudes and Intentions. *Journal of Experimental Psychology : Applied*.
9. Hacquin, A., **Altay, S.**, Aarøe, L., & Mercier, H. (2021) Fear of contamination and public opinion on nuclear energy. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*.
8. **Altay, S.**, Hacquin, AS. & Mercier, H. (2020) Why do so Few People Share Fake News? It Hurts Their Reputation. *New Media & Society*.
7. **Altay, S.**, Claidière, N. & Mercier, H. (2020) It Happened to a Friend of a Friend : Inaccurate Source Reporting In Rumor Diffusion. *Evolutionary Human Sciences*.
6. **Altay, S.** Majima. Y. & Mercier, H. (2020) It's My Idea! Reputation Management and Idea Appropriation. *Evolution & Human Behavior*.
5. Berriche, M. & **Altay, S.** (2020) Internet users engage more with phatic posts than with health misinformation on Facebook. *Palgrave Communications*.
4. **Altay, S.** & Mercier, H. (2020) Framing Messages for Vaccination Supporters. *Journal of Experimental Psychology : Applied*.
3. Marie, A., **Altay, S.** & Strickland, B. (2020) The Cognitive Foundations of Misinformation on Science. *EMBO reports*.
2. **Altay, S.** & Mercier, H. (2020) Relevance Is Socially Rewarded, But Not at the Price of Accuracy. *Evolutionary Psychology*.
1. **Altay, S.** & Lakhli, C. (2020) Are Science Festivals a Good Place to Discuss Heated Topics? *Journal of Science Communication*.

Book chapters, Comments, Reports, Essays.....

1. Scharfbillig, M., Lewandowsky, S., **Altay, S.**, van Alstyne, M., Kozyreva, A., et al. (2026). Fractured Reality : How Democracy Can Win the Global Struggle over the Information Space. *Publications Office of the European Union*. (Report)

2. **Altay, S.,** & Mercier, H. (2026) Misinformation is a symptom : Commentary on Ecker et al. 2024. *American Psychologist* (Comment).
3. Simon, F., & **Altay, S.** (2025) Don't Panic (Yet) : Assessing the Evidence and Discourse Around Generative AI and Elections *Knight First Amendment Institute*. (Essay)
4. **Altay, S.,** Valenzuela, S., & Howard, P. (2025) Trends in the Information Environment : 2025 Expert Survey Results. *International Panel on the Information Environment*. (Report)
5. **Altay, S.,** Valenzuela, S., & Howard, P. (2024) Trends in the Information Environment : 2024 Expert Survey Results. *International Panel on the Information Environment*. (Report)
6. Mercier, H. & **Altay, S.** (2022) Do cultural misbeliefs cause costly behavior? In Musolino, J., Hemmer, P. & Sommer, J. (Eds.) *The Science of Beliefs*. *Cambridge University Press*. (Book chapter)
7. **Altay, S.** & Mercier, H. (2020) Rationalizations primarily serve reputation management, not decision making. *Behavioral & Brain Sciences* (Comment)

File drawer.....

1. Hoes, E., **Altay, S.,** & Bermeo, J. (2023) Leveraging ChatGPT for Efficient Fact-Checking. *PysArXiv*.
2. Hacquin, AS. †, **Altay, S.**†, de Araujo, E. †, Chevallier, C. & Mercier, H. (2020) Sharp rise in vaccine hesitancy in a large and representative sample of the French population : reasons for vaccine hesitancy. *PysArXiv*.

International Conference & Workshop Presentations

1. Prevalence and impact of misinformation. *AFRAVIH*, Lausanne, Switzerland. **Talk**. (2026)
2. Who Is Concerned About Misinformation and Why? Evidence From 46 Countries Between 2018 and 2023. *American Political Science Association (APSA)*, Vancouver, Canada. **Talk**. (2025)
3. How effective are interventions against misinformation? A meta-analysis. *Swiss Psychological Society*, Crans-Montana, Switzerland. **Talk**. (2025)
4. How effective are interventions designed to help people detect misinformation? A meta-analysis. *European Political Science Association (EPSA)*, Madrid, Spain. **Talk**. (2025)
5. Spotting False News and Doubting True News : A Meta-Analysis of News Judgements. *Infox sur Seine*, Paris, France. **Keynote**. (2025)
6. News on Social Media Boosts Knowledge, Belief Accuracy, and Trust. A Field Experiment on Instagram and WhatsApp. *Digital Democracy Workshop*, Zurich, Switzerland. **Talk**. (2024)
7. News on Social Media Boosts Knowledge, Belief Accuracy, and Trust. A Field Experiment on Instagram and WhatsApp. *Annual Conference of the International Journal of Press/Politics*, Edinburgh, Scotland. **Talk**. (2024)
8. Spotting False News and Doubting True News : A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments. *European Digital Media Observatory (EDMO)*, Amsterdam, Netherlands. **Talk**. (2024)
9. How Effective Are Interventions Against Misinformation? *MISDOOM*, Boise, US. **Talk**. (2022)
10. Quantifying the “infodemic” : People turned to trustworthy news outlets during the 2020 pandemic. *American Political Science Association (APSA)*, Montréal, Canada. **Talk**. (2022)

11. How Effective Are Interventions Against Misinformation? *Conference on Online Hostility and Bystanders*, Aarhus, Denmark. **Talk.** (2022)
12. Why do so Few People Share Fake News? It Hurts Their Reputation. *MISDOOM*, Oxford Internet Institute, United Kingdom. **Talk.** (2021)
13. Happy Thoughts : The Role of Communion in Accepting and Sharing Epistemically Suspect Beliefs. *Human Behavior & Evolution Society* (HBES), Palm Springs, United States. **Talk.** (2021)
14. Why do so Few People Share Fake News? It Hurts Their Reputation. *International Conference on Thinking*, Paris, France. **Talk.** (2021)
15. It Happened to a Friend of a Friend : Inaccurate Source Reporting In Rumor Diffusion. *Cultural Evolution Society*, Sapporo, Japan. **Short Talk.** (2021)
16. It Happened to a Friend of a Friend : Inaccurate Source Reporting In Rumor Diffusion. *European Human Behavior & Evolution Association* (EHBEA), Krakow, Poland. **Short Talk.** (2021)
17. Why do so Few People Share Fake News? It Hurts Their Reputation. *Annual Evolutionary Psychology Preconference* (SPSP convention). **Short Talk.** (2021)
18. It Happened to a Friend of a Friend : Inaccurate Source Reporting In Rumor Diffusion. *California Workshop on Evolutionary Social Science* (C-WESS), California, United States. **Poster.** (2020)
19. It's My Idea! Reputation Management and Idea Appropriation. *Annual Evolutionary Psychology Preconference* (SPSP convention), New Orleans, United States. **Short Talk.** (2020)
20. Why do so Few People Share Fake News? It Hurts Their Reputation. *Research on Online Political Hostility* (ROPH), Aarhus, Denmark. **Poster.** (2020)
21. How to sound competent? The role of epistemic reputation in communication. *European Human Behavior & Evolution Association* (EHBEA), Toulouse, France. **Poster.** (2019)
22. Framing Messages for Vaccination Supporters. *International Convention of Psychological Science* (ICPS), Paris, France. **Poster.** (2019)
23. Framing Vaccine Communication to Increase Transmission. *New Perspectives & Methods on Social Cognition*, Aegina, Greece. **Poster.** (2018)

Invited Talks at International Conferences

1. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. Zoom Psychology & Law Symposium. Online Keynote talk. (2025)
2. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. FAKEPENAL : The public debate on Criminal law in the new digital communicative ecosystem. Alicante, Spain. (2024)
3. Reframing the problem of misinformation. Workshop on the Regulation of Disinformation. Frankfurt, Germany. (2023)
4. Keynote talk : Rethinking the problem of misinformation. TSHD Digital Humanities Symposium. Tilburg, The Netherlands. (2023)
5. Scaling up Interactive Argumentation by Providing Counterarguments with a Chatbot. Deliberation4Good. University of Cambridge, United Kingdom. (2022)

6. Understanding the spread of fake news. Beyond Fake News : Mitigating the Spread of Epistemically Toxic Content. University of Haifa, Israel. (2021)

Invited Talks at Lab Meetings & Local Conferences

1. Rethinking the Problem of Misinformation and Its Solutions. SHS Vaccination France. Online lecture. (2026)
2. Rethinking the Problem of Misinformation and Its Solutions. BCSS Discover and Discuss Research Seminar, University of Gloucestershire. Online lecture. (2026)
3. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. Markets and Strategy / Cognition and Behavior seminar, WU Vienna. Online lecture. (2026)
4. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. London Judgment & Decision Making Group. Online lecture. (2025)
5. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. Disinformation in times of crisis. EDMO Belux. Online lecture. (2025)
6. Don't Panic (Yet) : Assessing the Evidence and Discourse Around (Generative) AI and Elections. Knight Institute, symposium on AI and democratic freedoms. NYC, US (2025).
7. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. CEDAR seminar, Inria. Saclay, France (2024)
8. Impact and prevalence of false information. ANRS MIE. Paris, France (2024)
9. How should we label generative AI content on social media? Swiss-Korean Innovation Week. Seoul, South Korea (2024)
10. Is there a Big Disinfo problem? Big Disinfo workshop. Manchester, United Kingdom. (2024)
11. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. GPR-Psych seminar, Global Priorities Institute. University of Oxford, United Kingdom. (2024)
12. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. Disinformation in times of crisis. Deutsche Welle Akademie. Berlin. (2024)
13. Reframing the problem of misinformation. Kent Social Psychology Group meet. Kent, United Kingdom. (2023)
14. Reframing the problem of misinformation. Symposium : Democracy in the 21st Century, h21. Prague, Czech Republic. (2023)
15. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. JECIS. Nice, France. (2023)
16. Rethinking the problem of misinformation. CeSCuP, Bruxelles. (2023)
17. Fighting misinformation or fighting for information? Cambridge Social Decision-Making Lab. (2022)
18. Fighting misinformation or fighting for information? MIT. Human Cooperation Laboratory. (2022)
19. How Effective Are Interventions Against Misinformation? University of Bristol (TeDCog group), United Kingdom. Online lecture. (2022)
20. Challenging alarmist narratives on misinformation and questioning the effectiveness of interventions against misinformation. University of Zurich, Switzerland. (2022)

21. The psychology of fake news and COVID-19. Applied cognitive science webinar series, Jean Nicod Institute, Paris, France. (2022)
22. Contextualizing misinformation. European Commission. JRC mission on Disinformation. (2021)
23. Understanding the spread of fake news. TINT : Centre for Philosophy of Social Science, University of Helsinki, Finland. (2021)
24. Understanding and fighting misinformation. Montpellier Advanced Knowledge Institute on Transitions, Toulouse, France. (2021)
25. The psychology of fake news sharing. CEVIPOF, Sciences Po, Paris, France. (2020)
26. Fake News & Misinformation. UM6P, Collective intelligence Webinar. (2020)
27. How to Write a Registered Report. A researcher in 2019, École Normale Supérieure, Paris, France. (2019)

Grants

2026 GRC Short Grant. University of Zurich. 5 000 EUR.

2025 - 2027 UZH postdoc grant. On narratives about new information technologies. 200 000 EUR.

2018 - 2021 Thèse AID classique (Agence de l'Innovation de Défense). 130 000 EUR.

Teaching

Co-instructor

Spring 2021 - Building blocks in Social Cognition. *École Normale Supérieure, MA lectures*, N. Baumard and S. Altay. (24h)

Teaching assistant

Spring 2020 - Building blocks in Social Cognition. *École Normale Supérieure, MA lectures*, C. Chevallier and J. Grèzes. (36h)

Spring 2019 - Building blocks in Social Cognition. *École Normale Supérieure, MA lectures*, C. Chevallier and J. Grèzes. (36h)

Guest lectures

2025 - Rethinking the problem of misinformation. *LMU Munich, Master degree lecture*.

2025 - Rethinking misinformation and media effects. *École Normale Supérieure, Bachelor degree lecture*.

2025 - Rethinking the problem of misinformation. *EHESP, Bachelor degree lecture*.

2024 - Misinformation on misinformation. *Carnegie Mellon University*.

2023 - Rethinking misinformation and media effects. *University of Zurich, Master degree lecture*.

2024 - Misinformation. *Science Po Paris, Master degree lecture*.

2023 - Misinformation. *University of Zurich, Master degree lecture*.

2022 - Misconceptions about misinformation. *Case Western Reserve University, Bachelor degree lecture*.

2022 - Contextualizing Misinformation. *Brunel University London, Bachelor degree lecture*.

2022 - Myths and facts about misinformation and social media. *Lyon 1 University, Master degree lecture (IMST)*.

2021 - Contextualizing Misinformation on Social Media. *Brunel University London, Bachelor degree lecture.*

2021 - Communication, Misinformation and Reputation. *École Normale Supérieure, MA lecture.*

2020 - Introduction to Evolutionary Psychology. *Lyon 1 University, Bachelor degree lecture.*

2020 - Intuitions, Reasoning and Morality. *EHESS, MA lecture.*

2020 - Communication, Misinformation and Reputation. *École Normale Supérieure, MA lecture.*

2019 - Introduction to Evolutionary Psychology. *PSL Research University, Bachelor degree lecture.*

Supervision of students

2023 - 2025 : Jan Pfander (ENS; led to the publication of one article in *Nature Human Behaviour*)

2020 - 2021 : Alicia Herrera-Masurel (Cogmaster, ENS; led to the publication of one article)

2020 - 2021 : Syalie Liu (Cogmaster, ENS; led to the publication of one article)

2019 - 2020 : Emma de Araujo (Master of Sociology at Paris Descartes, led to the publication of two articles)

Thesis reviewer

Reviewed 3 master theses for the *Cogmaster, École Normale Supérieure.*

Professional Service

- Reviewer for a total of 87 articles : *NHB* (5), *Digital Journalism* (5), *Plos One* (5), *NMS* (5), *Nature Communications* (4), *Pol Com* (3), *HKS Misinformation Review* (3), *SM+S* (3), *American Psychologist* (2), *PNAS* (2), *Nature Climate Change*, *Nature Comp. Sci.*, *Psychological Science*, *JEP :G* (2), *JCOM* (2), *Pol Behaviour*, *NMS* (4), *IJPP* (2), *JESP*, *Cognition*, *IC&S*, *JEP :A*, *Current Direction in Psy. Sc.*, *Communications Psychology*, *JQD*, *BIT* (2), *Journalism Studies*, *Review of General Psychology*, *PSPB*, *Mind & Language*, *Royal Society Open Science*, *JASIST*, *Collabra : Psychology* (2), *PNAS Nexus*, *Cyberpsychology*, *EJHC*, *Scientific Reports* (2), *ISSID*, *IJPOR* (2), *jots*, *IJOC*, *SPB*, *Plos One* (5), *Advance.in*, *Philosophical Psychology*, *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*, *Nordicom Review*, *SCM*, *HSSC Nature* (2), *Frontiers Psychology*, *Thinking and Reasoning* (2), *SSCI*, *L'année Psychologique*.

- Guest editor for the journals : *PNAS Nexus* (1).

- Ad-hoc reviewer for the following grants and funding agencies : *Horizon*, *ERC*, *The French National Research Agency (ANR)*, *Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC)*.

Consulting

2023 - present : Consulting scientist for the International Panel on the Information Environment (IPIE). In charge of the annual expert survey on the information environment.

2025 : Consulting scientist for Association Square. Helping to design a media literacy intervention for young people from disadvantaged backgrounds.

Science Popularization

Press mentions.....

1. Conflict chambers, not echo chambers, on social media. **Verificat** (2026)
2. AI agent swarms in elections. **NZZ** (2026)
3. Health misinformation on TikTok. **Publico** (2026)
4. Unethical AI research on Reddit under fire. **Science** (2025)
5. Can you spot fake news? **Scientias** (2025)
6. Misinformation might sway elections — but not in the way that you think. **Nature** (2024)
7. Tiny number of ‘supersharers’ spread the vast majority of fake news. **Science** (2024)
8. ‘AI armageddon’ : Did artificially generated content really sway voters in 2024? **Logically Facts** (2024)
9. Are fears about online misinformation in the US election overblown? **Reuters Institute** (2024)
10. Don’t panic : AI can strengthen democracy too **Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists** (2024)
11. Elon Musk’s Community Notes Feature on X Is Working **Bloomberg** (2024)
12. Grand Dossier Écrans : les grands décerveurs? **Sciences humaines** (2024)
13. Réseaux sociaux : polarisent-ils les opinions? **Epsilon** (2024)
14. Why we need to talk less about disinformation **De Correspondent** (2024)
15. Social media : The X-odus **Research Professional News** (2024)
16. Why the ‘Flood of AI Misinformation’ Has Not Materialized as of yet **Dutch daily** (2024)
17. Désinformation : pourquoi donc partage-t-on des fausses informations en ligne? **De Facto** (2024)
18. Global climate change talks for TikTok generation **POLITICO** (2023)
19. Comment l’IA générative perturbe la couverture médiatique de la guerre Israël-Hamas **Usbek & Rica** (2023)
20. Tech Companies Are Taking Action on AI Election Misinformation. Will it Matter? **TIME** (2023)
21. Generative AI Is Playing a Surprising Role in Israel-Hamas Disinformation **WIRED** (2023)
22. X : How Elon Musk changed Twitter in one year **Deutsche Welle (DW)** (2023)
23. Un effet surestimé des réseaux sociaux lors des élections? Ce que disent les nouvelles études sur Facebook **De Facto** (2023)
24. Political Polarization Fuels Medical Misinformation **Bloomberg** (2023)
25. What the misinformation scare reveals about faith in democracy **The Washington Post** (2023)
26. Le fact-checking sert-il à quelque chose? Ce qu’en dit la science. **Le Parisien** (2023)
27. Le fact-checking sert-il à quelque chose? **Le Figaro** (2023)
28. New research highlights the misinformation about misinformation research **Psypost** (2022)
29. Disinformation : emergency or false problem? **Polytechnique insights** (2022)

30. Les fake news sont le plus souvent produites par intérêt financier" Entretien avec Sacha Altay. **Facts** (2021)

Panels & Public Talks.....

1. Talk and Round Table on Fake News Detection. **Hi! PARIS Meet Up, Station F** (2026)
2. Round Table : Responding to Disinformation. **Centre Climat-Société, Institut Pierre-Simon Laplace** (2026)
3. Round Table : Facts, Doubts and Climate Action — How to Tackle Disinformation? **École Normale Supérieure** (2026)
4. Fighting misinformation. **Conseil scientifique de l'éducation nationale** (2026)
5. Fighting misinformation. **Séance du Conseil Scientifique de l'ANSM** (2026)
6. Round Table : Geopolitics of Risk and AI. **École Normale Supérieure** (2026)
7. Everything You Know About Disinformation is Wrong. **DSI Disinformation Month, Zurich** (2024)
8. Rethinking misinformation & what (not) to do about it. **DSI Media Workshop, Zurich** (2024)
9. How effective are interventions against misinformation? **National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine** (2023)
10. Fighting misinformation or fighting for information? **Climate Action Against Disinformation (CAAD)** (2022)
11. Misinformation, the point of view of cognitive psychologists. **De facto** (2022)
12. Webinar on fake news and misinformation. **Direction Interministérielle de la Transformation Publique (DITP)** (2022)
13. Hearing on misinformation, social media and democracy. **Comission Bronner, for the french government** (2021)
14. Round Table : Unlocking Science : Prioritising Institutional Responses to Distrust in Science. International Science Council. **Berlin Science Week** (2021)
15. COVID-19 et mésinformation. Webinar. **Le Point** (2020)
16. The influence of disgust on human psychology. **Direction Interministérielle de la Transformation Publique (DITP)** (2019)
17. La psychologie des fake news. Audition publique sur l'hésitation vaccinale. **Assemblée nationale** (2019)
18. La psychologie des fake news. Fête de la science. **École Normale Supérieure** (2019)
19. Le mur des fake news. Qu'est-ce qu'une preuve scientifique? **Cité des sciences et de l'industrie** (2019)
20. « L'ami d'un ami s'est fait tuer par un dauphin! ». Étude sur la diffusion des rumeurs. **Colloque des jeunes chercheurs (Fresco)** (2019)
21. Les origines évolutionnaire de la raison humaine. **Séminaire de l'École Normale Supérieure** (2019)

22. Expliquer la culture par la théorie de l'évolution : Paris contre la Californie. **Cognivence** (2018)
23. Le mur des fake news. Qu'est-ce qu'une preuve scientifique? Fête de la science. **Université de Strasbourg** (2018)
24. Connais toi toi-même avec Darwin. Une approche cognitive et évolutionnaire des sciences de la personnalité. **Cognivence** (2017)

Podcasts & Interviews.....

1. Why we resist fake news better than we think (in French). **Réarmer la Démocratie** (2026)
2. Misinformation, Social Media, and Deepfakes. **Conspicuous Cognition** (2026)
3. The misinformation circus. **Podcast Državljan D** (2024)
4. Misinformation, Fake News & Conspiracy. **Behind the Stigma** (2023)
5. Misinformation, intellectual humility, and critical thinking. **Connecting cells** (2023)
6. Misinformation and Social Media. **Papier Crayon** (2022)
7. Misinformation and Climate Change. **In Over My Head Podcast** (2022)
8. Quantifying the 'infodemic' : People turned to trustworthy news outlets during the pandemic. **The Agenda, TVO** (2022)
9. Misinformation & trust in the news media. **KMO** (2022)
10. Misconceptions about misinformation (in French). **Projet Utopia** (2022)
11. Live stream on misinformation and distrust. **Kairos** (2022)
12. Misinformation, conspiracy theories, and communication strategies during the pandemic (in French). **Un verre avec** (2022)
13. Gullibility and misinformation (in French). **Cog Sci, Phil & Chill** (2021)
14. Social Media, Fake News, Science Communication, and the COVID-19 Pandemic. **The Dissenter** (2021)

Articles.....

1. AI's impact on elections is being overblown **MIT Technology Review** (2024)
2. Disinformation : People aren't as gullible as we think **Deutsche Welle Akademie** (2024)
3. Against fake news, we need to create "steel men" **Libération** (2022)
4. "If this account is true, it is most enormously wonderful" : Interestingness-if-true and the sharing of true and false news. *Imperfect Cognitions*. (2021)
5. "Sister I Love You!" Facebook users engage more with social posts than health misinformation. **BMC On Society** (2020)
6. What's the recipe? **Cognition and Culture** (2020)
7. De l'utilité des chamailleries scientifiques. **Phébé, Le Point** (2020)
8. Fact check : Trois infox sur les infox. **The Conversation** (2020)
9. Le paradoxe des infox. **Phébé, Le Point** (2020)
10. Le bruit et la rumeur. **Phébé, Le Point** (2020)

11. Nous ne sommes pas nés de la dernière pluie! **Phébé, Le Point** (2020)
12. De l'autre côté de la machine. **Science & pseudo-sciences** (2020)
13. Tout ce que vous pensiez savoir d'Internet est (sans doute) faux. **Phébé, Le Point** (2020)
14. Je me souviens, donc je te fais confiance. **Phébé, Le Point** (2019)
15. Le cerveau en lumières. **Science & pseudo-sciences** (2019)
16. Pourquoi nous aimons les ours en peluche. **Phébé, Le Point** (2019)
17. Factfulness. **Science & pseudo-sciences** (2019)
18. Les vraies raisons du succès des infox. **Phébé, Le Point** (2019)
19. Qui a peur des chambres d'échos? **Phébé, Le Point** (2019)
20. Des intelligences très artificielles. **Science & pseudo-sciences** (2019)
21. Jusqu'où sommes-nous prêts à aller pour sauver notre réputation? **Phébé, Le Point** (2019)
22. De l'esprit au cerveau. **Science & pseudo-sciences** (2019)
23. The Problem with the Way Scientists Study Reason. **Nautilus** (2018)
24. Apprendre! Les talents du cerveau, le défi des machines. **Science & pseudo-sciences** (2019)
25. Les enfants, ces scientifiques en puissance. **Phébé, Le Point** (2019)
26. Les OGM, victimes de la nature humaine. **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
27. Souriez, on vous observe! **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
28. De l'importance de la nature pour comprendre la culture. **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
29. Pourquoi nous préférons les inégalités. **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
30. Pourquoi le milieu joue sur notre biologie. **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
31. La méthode Galilée pour convaincre. **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
32. Connaître ses biais cognitifs pour mieux recruter. **Phébé, Le Point** (2018)
33. Murmurer à l'oreille de l'éléphant. Qu'est-ce que le raisonnement moral? **Phébé, Le Point** (2017)
34. Les vrais et faux du visage. **Phébé, Le Point** (2017)
35. Comment les religions sont devenues morales. **Phébé, Le Point** (2017)
36. L'homme n'est pas si crédule qu'on croit **Phébé, Le Point** (2017)
37. Les découvertes de la science sur la raison. **Phébé, Le Point** (2017)
38. Pourquoi avons-nous peur des vaccins? **Cog Innov** (2017)